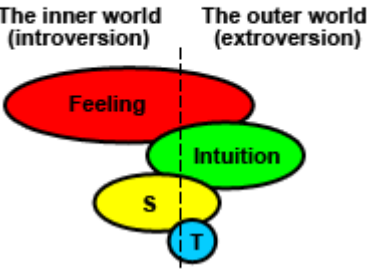


Cognitive Functions

Cognitive functions are the technical term for “Modes of processing information and making decisions based on your Myers-Briggs type.” Each type has four (out of a possible eight) cognitive functions, which they use in a specific order. Identifying which functions you use – and in what order – is the most accurate way to type yourself or anyone else.

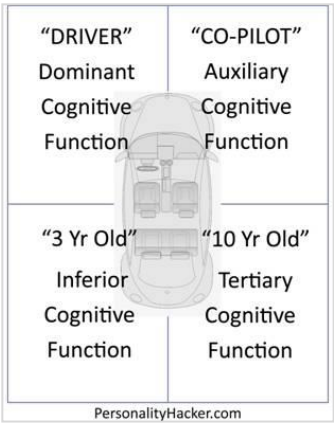
INFP Functions INFP Primary Processes



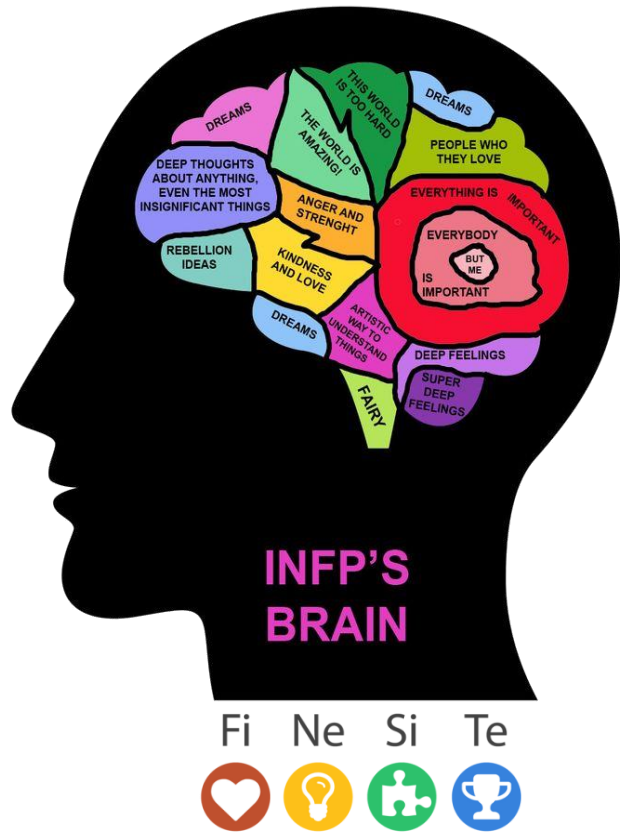
Role	Process	Snapshot
Leading “Driver”	Introverted Feeling	Valuing and considering importance, beliefs, and worth
Supportive “Co-Pilot”	Extroverted iNtuition	Interpreting situations and relationships and pickup meanings and interconnections to other contexts
Relief “10 year old”	Introverted Sensing	Reviewing and recalling past experiences and seeking detailed data
Aspirational “3 year old”	Extroverted Thinking	Segmenting, organising for efficiency, and systematising

The analogy of a car is a useful model when thinking about cognitive functions. The first function is the ‘driver’ of the personality type and is the function from which perspective of all of the other functions follow. It provides the direction and speed. The second function is the ‘co-pilot’, which navigates around or through any difficulties encountered. The inferior, or 3 year old, function attempts to distract both primary and secondary functions whereas the tertiary function, or ‘10 year old’, only distracts the current dominant function.

Understanding cognitive functions is imperative to understanding type. The four-letter dichotomies cannot possibly explain the complexity of our personalities – we are all thinkers, feelers, sensors and intuitives in various situations. The cognitive functions allow us to understand when we use each function and how it impacts our decision-making process.



The Cognitive Functions



Role	Process	Snapshot
Ne	Extroverted Intuition	How do concepts happen outside me?
Ni	Introverted Intuition	How do concepts happen within me.
Fe	Extroverted Feeling	How does this make others feel.
Fi	Introverted Feeling	Experiencing and acting in the immediate context
Te	Extroverted Thinking	How does this logically affect things.
Ti	In troverted Thinking	How does this logically affect me?
Se	Extroverted Sensing	How is the environment outside me?
Si	Introverted Sensing	How is the environment inside me?

CONCLUSION

INFP Dreamers are highly idealistic. They defend their values and do not like to have them challenged. They are catalysts for harmony and healing.

Their greatest contribution is their ability to be present with another person at a deep level.



What is MBTI?

Myers-Briggs Type Indicator (MBTI) is a tool that helps people gain insights about themselves and how they interact with others—and improve how they communicate, learn, and work.

Often referred to as a ‘personality test’, MBTI actually has less to do with one’s personality and everything to do with how their brain works from receiving and processing external information to communication preferences. These preferences are split into four pairs – I/E, S/N, F/T and J/P. Though everyone is unique and will have some traits of all 8 letters, people will often be more inclined towards one letter in each pair. By determining your preference in each group, and putting these four letters together, you get your personality **type code** – for you, this is **INFP**.

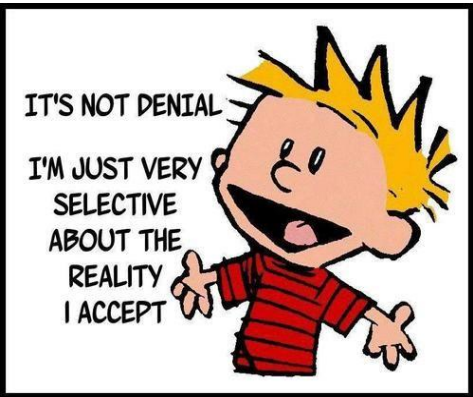
INFP – The Healer What does that mean?

- Introverted Energised by quiet time alone
- iNtuitive Focus on ideas and concepts
- Feeling Prioritises people and emotions
- Perceiving Prefers freedom and flexibility

Deeply sensitive, INFP are Imaginative idealists characterised by their loyal and gentle nature. Beneath their easy-going disposition runs a fixed passion for the causes they believe in and the people they selflessly care for. Seeing potential for a better future, INFPs pursue truth and meaning with their own individual flair. They are driven by their values and seek peace.

INFPs direct their energy inward. They are energised by spending time alone. They are private and internally aware. INFPs are independent and keep to themselves most of the time. INFPs are Intuitive, imaginative, idealistic and creative people. They generate endless possibilities and ideas. Their thought process is profound and abstract. INFPs live in the future.

Driven by emotion, INFPs are Feelers that make decisions with their heart. They dislike conflict and are easily hurt. Random and spontaneous, INFPs like to keep their options open and dislike feeling confined by unbending rules and schedules.



Being a part of the Diplomat personality group, INFPs are guided by their principles, rather than by logic (Analysts), excitement (Explorers), or practicality (Sentinels). When deciding how to move forward, they will look to honour, beauty, morality and virtue – INFPs are led by the purity of their intent, not rewards and punishments.

INFP personalities are true idealists, always looking for the hint of good in even the worst of people and events, searching for ways to make things better. While they may be perceived as calm, reserved, or even shy, INFPs have an inner flame and passion that can truly shine.

Strengths

- Idealistic** – INFPs have an unshaken belief that all people are inherently good.
- Seek and Value Harmony** – Preferring a more democratic approach, INFPs don’t care for having power over others or domineering attitudes.
- Open-Minded and Flexible** – So long as their principles and ideas are not being challenged, INFPs embrace a live-and-let-live attitude, supporting others’ right to do what they think is right. They dislike being constrained by rules.
- Very Creative** – INFPs combine their intuitive nature with their open-mindedness to allow them to see things from unconventional perspectives.
- Passionate and Energetic** – When something captures INFPs’ imagination and speaks to their beliefs, they go all in, dedicating their time, energy, thoughts and emotions to the project.
- Dedicated and Hard-Working** – Knowing that what they are doing is meaningful gives people with this personality type a sense of purpose and even courage when it comes to accomplishing something they believe in.

Weaknesses

- Too Idealistic** – INFPs often take their idealism too far, setting themselves up for disappointment as, again and again, evil things happen in the world.
- Too Altruistic** – INFPs sometimes see themselves as selfish, but only because they want to give so much more than they are able to.
- Dislike Dealing With Data** – Strongly focused on the big picture, INFPs may forget the forest is made of individual trees. In tune with emotions and morality, when the facts and data contradict their ideals, it can be a real challenge for INFPs.
- Take Things Personally** – INFPs often take challenges and criticisms personally, rather than as inspiration to reassess their positions.
- Difficult to Get to Know – INFPs are private, reserved and self-conscious. This makes them notoriously difficult to really get to know.



INFPs may initially seem cool, as they reserve their most authentic thoughts and feelings for people they know well. They are reflective and often spiritual, and often interested in having meaningful conversations about values, ethics, people, and personal growth. Typically curious and open-minded, the Healer continually seeks a deeper understanding of themselves and of the people around them. They are passionate about their ideals, but private as well; few people understand the depth of the INFP's commitment to their beliefs.

INFPs are sensitive and empathetic, and engage themselves in a lifelong quest for meaning and authenticity. The mundane aspects of life are of less interest to this type, and they are more excited by interesting ideas than by practical facts. They typically accept others without question, and may take special interest in offbeat points of view or alternative lifestyles. They often have a special affection for the arts, especially the avant-garde, as they love experiencing new concepts in self-expression.



- Albert Schweitzer, *Theologian, Doctor, Pianist*
- Princess Diana, *Princess of Wales*
- William Shakespeare, *Poet, Playwright*
- Helen Keller, *Author, Activist, Lecturer*
- John F. Kennedy, Jr., *Lawyer, Publisher*
- Neil Diamond, *Singer, Musician*
- Audrey Hepburn, *Actress*
- J. R. R. Tolkien, *Author (Lord of the Rings)*
- Peter Jackson, *Filmmaker (LOTR)*



At work, the INFP is not particularly driven by money or status, preferring work that aligns with their personal values and allows them to help others. INFPs are typically motivated by vision and inspiration, and want to engage with projects and causes that feel important to them. They enjoy the process of creative problem-solving, and want to understand complex issues. An ideal job for a Healer allows them to express their individuality in the way they work, and takes advantage of their ability to see unique solutions.

As subordinates: INFPs are not looking for easy, forgettable work that pays the bills, but for meaningful work, and it helps for their managers to frame responsibilities in terms of emotional merit rather than cold rationalisation. INFPs would rather know that their work will help to deliver a service they believe in than to know that the bottom line has been boosted by 3%.

As colleagues: INFPs feel most comfortable among colleagues – they aren't interested in controlling others, and have a similar distaste for being controlled. INFPs don't like conflict or picking sides, and will do everything they can to maintain harmony and cooperation.

As managers: INFPs egalitarian attitudes lend respect to every subordinate, preferring communication as human beings than as a boss/employee opposition. Flexible and open-minded, they keep their eyes on the horizon, set goals that achieve a desirable end, and help the people working under them to make that happen.

Career Matches

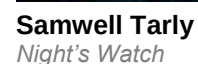
- Educational Consultant
- Social Worker
- Physical Therapist
- Fashion Designer
- Counselor
- Teacher
- Musician
- Therapist
- Actor/Actress
- Artist
- Journalist
- Filmmaker
- Editor
- Graphic Designer
- Writer
- Psychologist
- Translator/Interpreter
- Social Scientist
- Web Designer
- Photographer
- Human Resources
- Video Editor
- Speech Pathologist
- Researcher

Popular INFJ hobbies

- Poetry
- Creative writing
- Music
- Photography
- Theatre
- Visual art



Game of Thrones:



Disney:



Nurturing, empathic, and loyal, Healers select their friends and partners carefully, looking for a strong bond and congruent values. They are self-aware and often spiritual. INFPs' tend to focus their attention on just a few people in their lives and approach new relationships wholeheartedly, with a sense of inherent value, dedication and trust. INFPs are typically open-minded and accepting of another's behaviour and preferences, so long as their core values are not violated, and look for ways to compromise and accommodate other people. They can be very sensitive, but may keep negative reactions to themselves because they are reluctant to engage in confrontation. They value a partner who is committed and loving, yet provides them with the support they need to independently explore the mysteries of life.

They look for affirmation, affection and integrity. They are good at identifying inconsistencies in themselves and others. INFPs are romantics.

Kindred spirits:

INTP, INFJ, ENFP

Intriguing differences:

ISFP, INTJ, ENTP, ENFJ

ISTJ, ESTP, ESTJ and ESFJ personalities can clash and conflict with the INFP, but may also offer the best opportunities for growth. With fundamentally different values and motivations, their strengths are the INFP's weaknesses, and if they are able to develop a relationship, they can learn a tremendous amount from each other.



INFP become burnt out or overwhelmed if:

- forced to socialise for long periods of time
- forced to comply with authority figures, or expectations of those around them.

Being forced to behave like everyone else, can become extremely exhausting for an INFP. In work situations where they need to comply with the demands of their boss, INFPs will quickly feel overwhelmed, and like they are about to crack.

They normally are good at keeping their composure and their emotions in check, the INFP who is burnt out, is extremely on edge, short tempered, and might snap at people. The INFP needs to make time for themselves when they can: revert to things that comfort them and ease their minds or, if possible, a small vacation might be in order.



people/work impeding on individuality

MUNDANE WORK NEGATIVITY FROM OTHERS

time management
required of me

disharmony

being met with criticism

CRITICAL **STRESS THAT** **TIRED** shutting down my

being **INFP** ideas

being rushed

GET ME SPINNING

unclear expectations

open disrespect

VALUES UNDERMINED OR CHALLENGED

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Change

INFPs often enjoy some change in their life, but need certain things to remain stable. They want relationships that are lifelong and committed, the INFP will dislike if they change in bad ways. This type of change is very upsetting to an INFP, and they will need time to come to terms with it. Small change is something that they often welcome and enjoy. INFPs like for things to be new and exciting, making minimal changes pleasant for them. When they are younger the INFP often likes the idea of making changes to their lives, in an attempt to figure out what truly makes them happy, but as adults they probably find less enjoyment in change, since they have already gone through many changes.

